Rutuja Deshpande

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A Mixed-Methods UX Researcher Specializing In AI-Assisted Research Workflows & Data-Informed Product Strategy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Design Research Intern, Privoce, Remote *[May 2026 - Present]*

- Led a **formative research study end to end** on freelancer video-collaboration workflows; wrote the protocol and discussion guide, and recruited and screened participants across LinkedIn, communities, and referrals
- Recommended **repositioning VoceSpace toward enterprise teams**, after finding freelancers mainly use whatever call platform their client picks; synthesized interviews using AI transcription & affinity mapping in Miro
- Found freelancers took privacy seriously but followed clients' rules, since clients had more to lose and freelancers mainly risked their credibility, making **privacy a weaker selling point** for individual users

UX Researcher, Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh *[Jan 2025 - May 2025]*

- Co-designed and conducted **15 semi-structured interviews** evaluating user comprehension of Apple's App Store privacy label definitions, developing screening criteria and using Qualtrics to ensure a qualified sample
- Built a structured interview protocol and a research instrument, combining definition-to-term matching tasks and term-selection questions to isolate phrases driving participant comprehension gaps
- Initiated & applied **inductive coding scheme** across transcripts, surfacing that jargon caused confusion while concrete examples improved comprehension, bringing clarity to team's synthesis and final conclusions
- Redesigned ambiguous privacy label definitions based on findings and tested them against Apple's originals in a follow-up preference survey; **~70% of users preferred the revised versions**

Decision Analytics Associate Consultant / Associate, ZS Associates, India *[Feb 2022 - Jul 2024]*

- Delivered insights from multi-country data analysis that shaped portfolio strategy for a **$100B pharma client**
- Presented portfolio analysis findings to **senior client leadership**, shaping strategic planning decisions
- Led segmentation analysis for a new product that redirected 3+ months of planning
- Worked with **cross-functional** clients and internal teams to align on analysis; mentored 10+ team members
- Recognized as Ace Associate for significant client impact within 1 year of joining

Business Analyst and Development Executive, Envirofoods, India *[Jun 2020 - Sep 2021]*

- **Owned go-to-market strategy** for new product line; **revenue doubled** within the following quarter
- Noticed flavor fatigue in repeat customers through observation; expanded beverage line from 5 to 10 flavors
- Identified a shopkeeper-reported preference for local-language packaging; **collaborated with a designer** to design and implement it, and sales grew ~15% in the following months

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, Heinz College, Pittsburgh, PA *[Aug 2024 - Aug 2025]*
Master of Information Systems Management (GPA: 4.0) | Dean's List

Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India *[Aug 2016 - May 2020]*
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science (GPA: 3.56)

SKILLS

UX Research and Design: Discussion guide design, participant recruitment, semi-structured interviewing, inductive coding & thematic analysis, affinity mapping, Design Thinking, Survey Design, Competitive Analysis, A/B Testing

Tools and Platforms: Qualtrics, Miro, Prolific, Figma, Google Workspace, Power BI, Tableau, Excel

AI/GenAI: Claude, ChatGPT, prompt engineering (GPT-4) - directed strategy for GPT-4 to classify ESG requirements, validating 10,000+ records and cutting manual effort ~98% *(CMU capstone)*

Data & Business Intelligence: Python, SQL, R, VBA, Agile, Statistical Analysis, KPI Dashboards, Data Visualization

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Interaction Design Foundation (IxDF)

- User Research: Methods and Best Practices *(2026)*
- Data Driven Design: Quantitative Research for UX *(2026)*